



RVSR JOB AID

Hospitalization/Convalescence

Hospitalization (38 CFR 4.29) and Convalescence (38 CFR 4.30) benefits are temporary total rating increases. This job aid is available to RVSRs for rating claims for Temporary Total Disability due to Hospitalization and/or Convalescence.

Table 1: Hospitalization/Convalescence Job Aid

	Hospitalization	Convalescence
Service Connection	Hospitalization/treatment must be for a service connected disability – no exceptions.	Convalescence period must be for a service connected disability – no exceptions.
Criteria	Must relate to <u>both</u> of the following: • Hospitalized for at least 21 days • Treatment or observation must be provided by either a Department of Veteran's Affairs Medical Center (VAMC) or an approved hospital The provision of 38 CFR 4.29 DO NOT apply if the Veteran: • Is treated as a resident in a State Veteran's home • Is currently receiving a total rating of the disability for which hospitalization was required • Is a resident in a VA domiciliary program, or	Must relate to <u>one</u> of the following: • Surgery requiring at least one month of convalescence • Surgery with severe post-operative residuals • Immobilization of at least one major joint by cast without surgery



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	- Is a participant in a live-in/work out program being utilized to facilitate transition to community living Exceptions: - Hospitalization in excess of 21 days for an SC disability in a medical facility located at a State Veterans' home may entitle the Veteran to hospitalization benefits. - Veterans are entitled to hospitalization benefits for treatment in excess of 21 days in a day hospital program if the treatment given is consistent with hospital care for a SC disability even though they are concurrently required to be housed in a VA domiciliary	
Effective Date	The date the Veteran was admitted into the VA hospital or authorized non-VA hospital.	The date of hospital admission or the date of entitling treatment.
Duration of Benefits	Should continue through the end of the month of discharge from the treatment facility when temporary total disability has been approved.	The length of convalescence period varies but can continue for a period of 1, 2, or 3 months from the first day of the month following such hospital discharge or outpatient release.
Resources	38 CFR 4.29 - hospitalization 38 CFR 17.52 -17.53 - approved hospital - M21-1 IV.ii.2J – Compensation under 38 CFR 4.28, 38 CFR 4.29, and 38 CFR 4.30	38 CFR 4.30 – convalescence 38 CFR 4.45(f) – major joints